



Chocolate Chip Ice Cream Sandwich Bars

What's the biggest challenge with homemade ice cream sandwiches? The sandwich part is frozen too solid to bite while the ice cream is too soft to hold its shape. Well, not with these treats! The chocolate chip cookie bars stay beautifully soft even when frozen. And thanks to our all-in-one freezing technique, the no-churn homemade ice cream inside (chocolate or vanilla, your choice) remains stable and drip-free bite after delicious bite.



PREP

30 mins

BAKE

15 to 18
mins

TOTAL

9 hrs

YIELD

16 bars, size
will vary

Ingredients

Bars

- 8 tablespoons (113g) unsalted butter
- 1 1/4 cups (266g) light brown sugar or dark brown sugar, packed
- 3/4 teaspoon table salt
- 1 teaspoon King Arthur Pure Vanilla Extract
- 3 large eggs
- 1 3/4 cups (210g) King Arthur Unbleached All-Purpose Flour
- 1 1/2 teaspoons baking powder
- 1/3 cup (59g) mini chocolate chips

Filling

- 2 cups (454g) heavy cream or whipping cream
- 14-ounce can (397g) sweetened condensed milk
- 1 teaspoon King Arthur Pure Vanilla Extract
- 1/4 teaspoon table salt
- 2/3 cup (113g) semisweet chocolate or bittersweet chocolate, melted, optional

Instructions

- ① Preheat the oven to 350°F. Line a 13" x 18" rimmed baking sheet (half-sheet pan) with parchment and lightly grease the parchment.
- ② **To make the bars:** Melt the butter and whisk in the brown sugar. Add the salt and vanilla, stirring until smooth.
- ③ If the mixture is uncomfortably hot to the touch, allow it to cool a bit before adding the eggs all at once. Whisk until smooth.
- ④ Stir in the flour and baking powder.
- ⑤ By this time the batter should be no more than lukewarm; stir in the chips. Use a spatula to spread the batter in the prepared pan, making a thin, even layer all the way to the edges.
- ⑥ Bake the bars for 15 to 18 minutes, until they're set in the middle and just starting to turn golden brown. Remove from the oven and cool completely before assembling the sandwiches.
- ⑦ **To make the ice cream:** In a stand mixer with the whisk attachment, beat the heavy cream, condensed milk, vanilla, and salt on medium speed until medium peaks form.
- ⑧ If you want to make chocolate ice cream, whisk in the melted chocolate.
- ⑨ **To assemble:** Remove the bar from the baking sheet and cut it in half vertically to make two pieces approximately 8 1/2" x 12" each.
- ⑩ Line a 9" x 13" pan with plastic wrap, allowing it to generously overhang on all sides. Place one of the bars in the pan, bottom side up.

Toppings, optional

- coarse sparkling sugar
- cocoa nibs
- sprinkles

- ⑪ Top the bar with the whipped, unfrozen ice cream. Spread it to the edges, leaving about 1/2" on every side bare.
- ⑫ Place the other bar on top of the ice cream bottom side down, gently pressing down to evenly spread the ice cream to the edges. It's OK if some of the ice cream oozes out the sides.
- ⑬ Using the overhanging wrap, completely cover and tightly wrap the assembled sandwich.
- ⑭ Place the pan in the freezer overnight. The filling takes longer than a few hours to freeze solid, so it's important to give the sandwich plenty of time to freeze.
- ⑮ **To serve:** Remove the sandwich from the freezer. Unwrap and place it on a cutting board.
- ⑯ For the neatest look, trim the edges off the sandwich (baker's treat!). Cut into bars that are the size and shape of your choice.
- ⑰ Dip the edges of each bar into the topping of your choice; we like sparkling sugar, cocoa nibs, or sprinkles. Serve immediately.
- ⑱ **Storage information:** Store the cut bars, individually wrapped, in the freezer for up to three months.

Tips from our Bakers

- ☆ Be sure to use mini chips in these bars; or break full-size chips into smaller pieces. Larger (standard) chips can be unpleasantly hard when frozen.
- ☆ Want to get more creative with your ice cream flavor? Go right ahead! Aim for about 5 cups of your favorite homemade or store-bought ice cream in place of the above filling. Let the ice cream soften for 20 to 25 minutes so it's easily spreadable; assemble, freeze, and serve as directed above.
- ☆ These bars keep exceptionally well in the freezer. Feel free to make them well ahead for any summertime celebration.
- ☆ **Want to make this recipe gluten-free?** For great results, substitute King Arthur Gluten-Free Measure for Measure Flour for the all-purpose flour in this recipe. Be sure to bake thoroughly; gluten-free baked goods often need a bit more time in the oven.

We're here to help. King Arthur Baker's Hotline: (855) 371 2253